



Kia Soul EV

Also part of its 16-car entourage was the Kia Soul – the only fully electrified car presented in India by Kia at the Auto Expo 2018. The Kia Soul stands alongside the Niro and Optima plug-in hybrids, and may be launched in India when Kia begins shipping its cars on Indian roads from 2019. The Kia Soul EV is expected to be the only EV offering from Kia, which has stated its intention of targeting the mass market categories to begin with. The Soul EV hatchback, hence, may well go up against Mahindra's offerings when it starts selling in the country. It would also be ideal for Kia to begin with at least one EV in its India lineup, since we do expect a greater push for electric cars by 2019, when Kia's cars hit the roads in India.

BMW's i lineup

The BMW zone at Auto Expo 2018 was strewn with the likes of the X6 M Sport, M3 and M5 performance sedans and even the venomous M4 coupe, but the one zone that definitely attracted a lot of eyeballs was BMW's i arena, presenting both the i8 Roadster, and the i3s family hatch. BMW's i division stands for electric mobility without compromising on performance, which we saw clearly in our drive of the BMW i8. Now, the company is set to bring the Roadster edition of the i8 to the country, along with the i3s. The two cars come with plug-in hybrid and electric powertrains, although the iDrive infotainment system powering these have now started showing its age in face of swanky, cutting-edge in-cabin tech from other car makers.

While the BMW i8 Roadster was also present on BMW's show floor, what caught a lot of eyes is the flash red-and-black i3s luxury hatch. The BMW i3s will be launched in India this year, although pricing remains in question. As such, the BMW i3s is expected in India in fully electric form, and may well become the first luxury car in India to come with an all-electric powertrain to be officially available.



Renault: Zoe, Trezor concept

The Renault Zoe is a compact hatchback with decent ground clearance and interior space. These three factors make it quite well suited for Indian soil, and although there is no confirmation on whether it will come to India, spotting it at Auto Expo 2018 has raised rumours regarding its impending arrival in the country. The Renault Zoe might just be a success as EVs ramp up in India, seeing how well positioned it is, and Renault may use this to increase its fortune on Indian soil.

The Trezor, meanwhile, would presumably continue to remain a concept, and it certainly will not be swooshing into production charts in a hurry. When it does, we certainly expect it to drop the red-bathed cabin, as it does not really make practical sense in the long run.

That notwithstanding, the Trezor is a glimpse at the kind of technology that Renault has for store in the long run. It cannot be implemented as production models just yet, but we do hope that certain elements from it will trickle down to other models in the near future. 